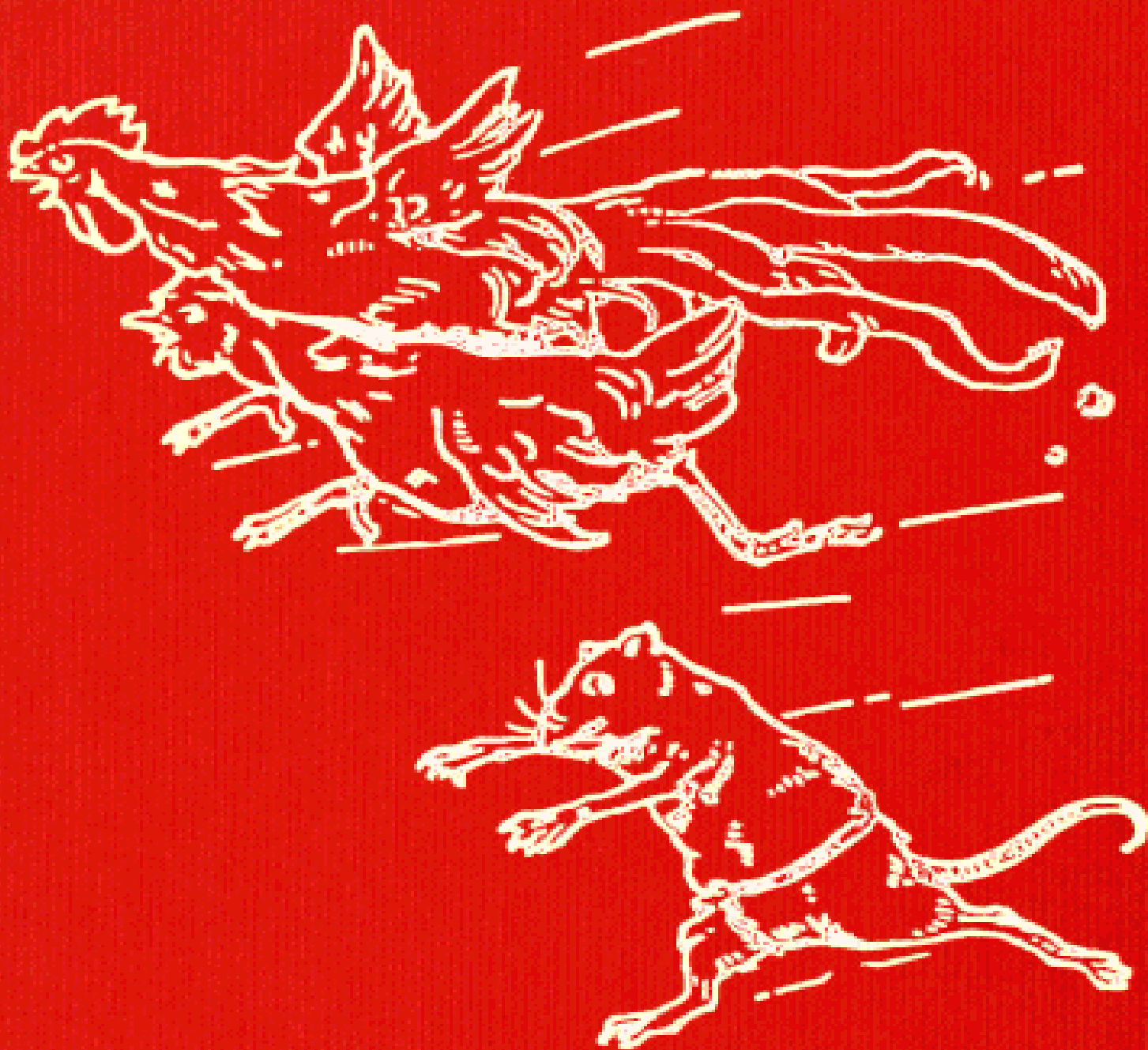




THE COCK
THE MOUSE
AND THE
LITTLE RED HEN



THE COCK
THE MOUSE
AND THE
LITTLE RED HEN

The Project Gutenberg eBook of The cock, the mouse, and the little red hen

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an old tale retold

Author: Félicité Lefèvre

Illustrator: Tony Sarg

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*** START OF THE PROJECT GUTENBERG EBOOK THE COCK,
THE MOUSE, AND THE LITTLE RED HEN ***

The original (printed) book came in at least two versions. In the edition used for this e-text, some full-color illustrations had a red frame and the others were unframed. The line drawings alternated between reddish magenta and blue-green. In another version, all color illustrations had the same black frame, and all line drawings were black-and-white. In this e-text, red frames are as printed; black frames were added by the transcriber to make illustrations look cleaner.



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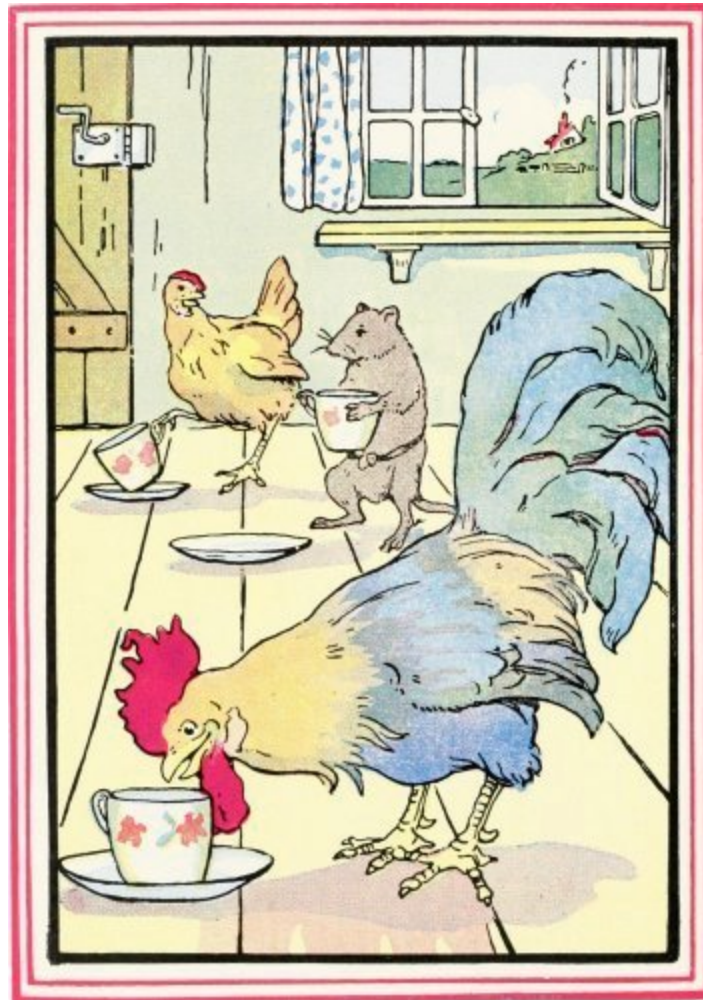
[Note on](#)

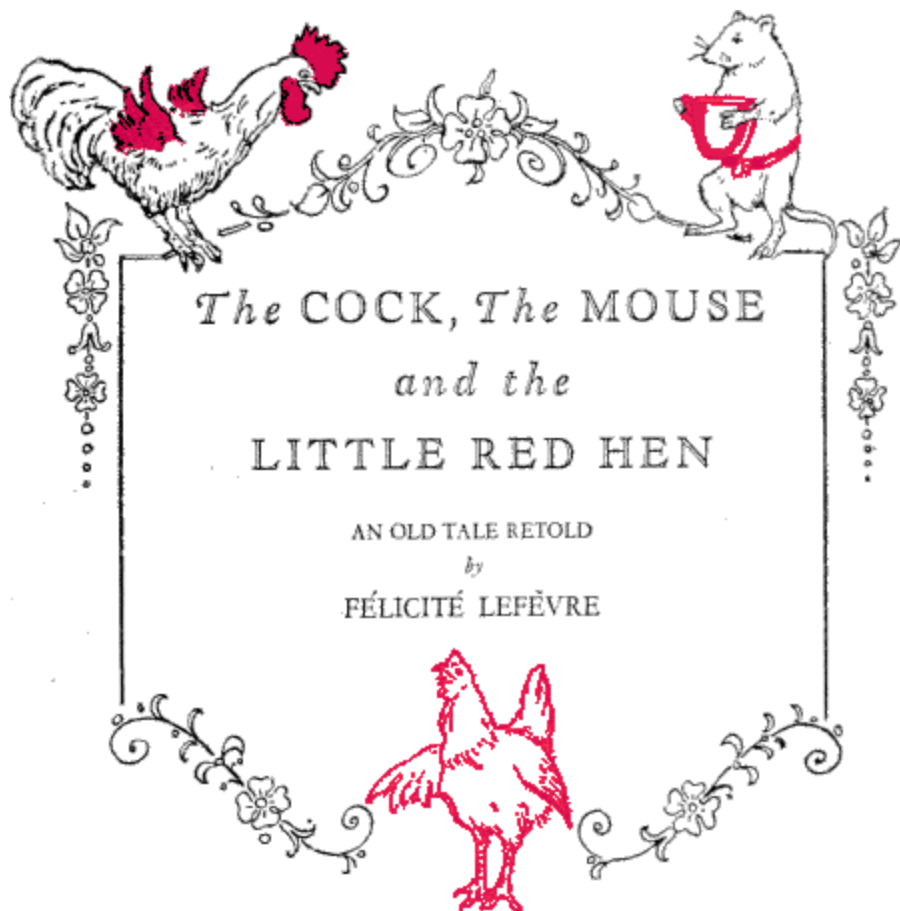
[Colors](#)



THE COCK, THE MOUSE

AND THE LITTLE RED HEN





The COCK, *The* MOUSE
and the
LITTLE RED HEN

AN OLD TALE RETOLD
by
FÉLICITÉ LEFÈVRE

WITH 24 ILLUSTRATIONS
by
TONY SARG

MACRAE • SMITH • COMPANY
PHILADELPHIA

TO MY NIECES
CECILIA GARRY and NELLY MELVILLE

AND

TO MY LITTLE FRIEND

HARFORD LURY

THIS BOOK IS DEDICATED

WITH MY LOVE

4511

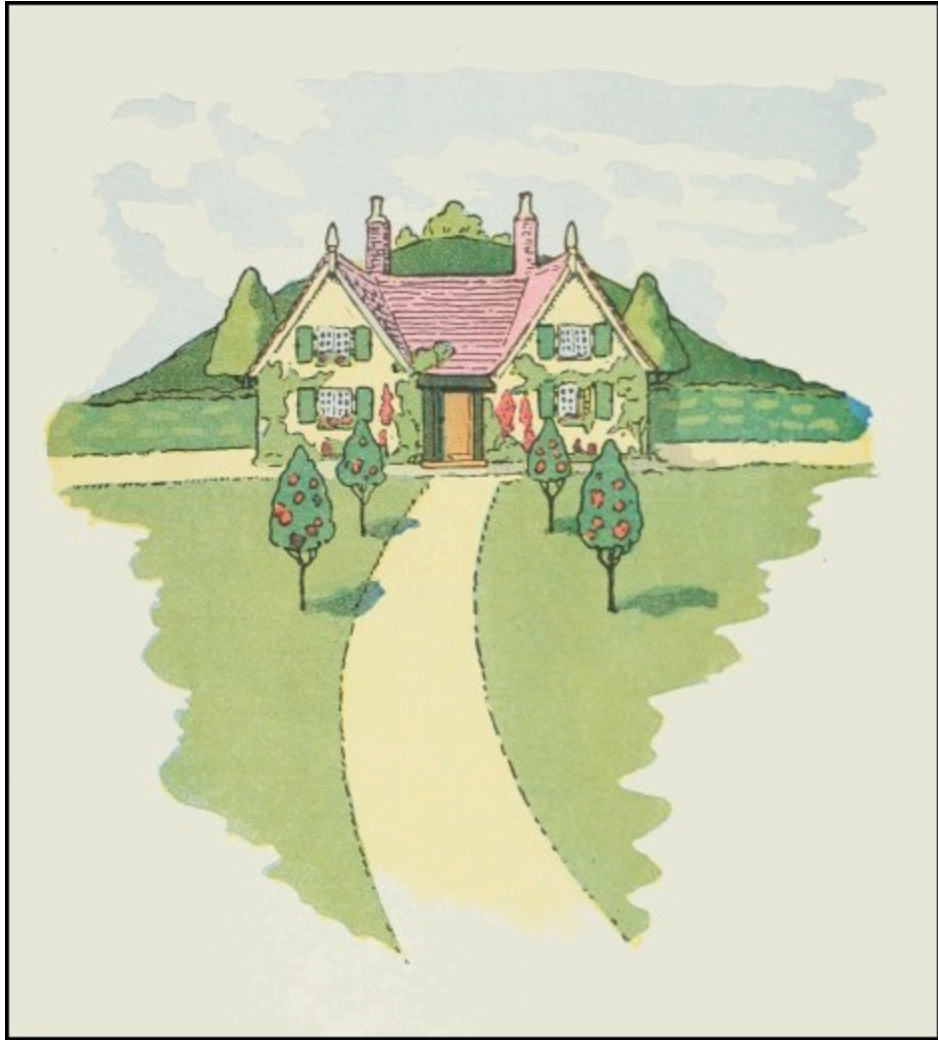
NINETEENTH PRINTING

Manufactured in the United States of America

THE COCK, THE MOUSE AND THE LITTLE RED HEN

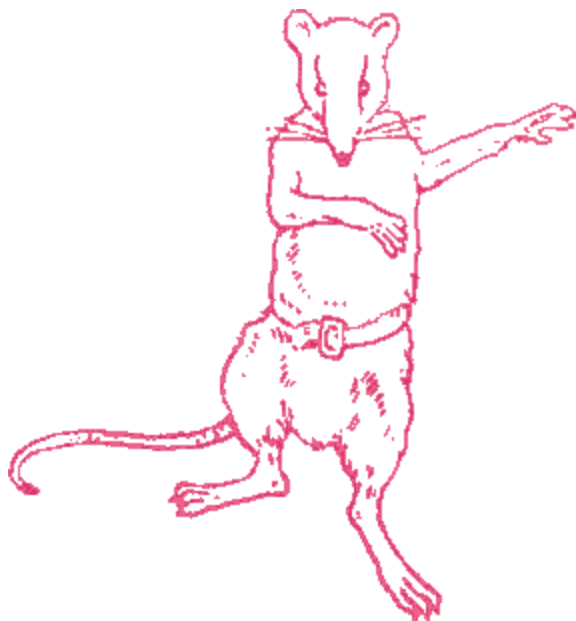
Once upon a time there was
a hill, and on the hill there
was a pretty little house.

It had one little green
door, and four little windows
with green shutters,
and in it there lived





A Cock



and A Mouse

and

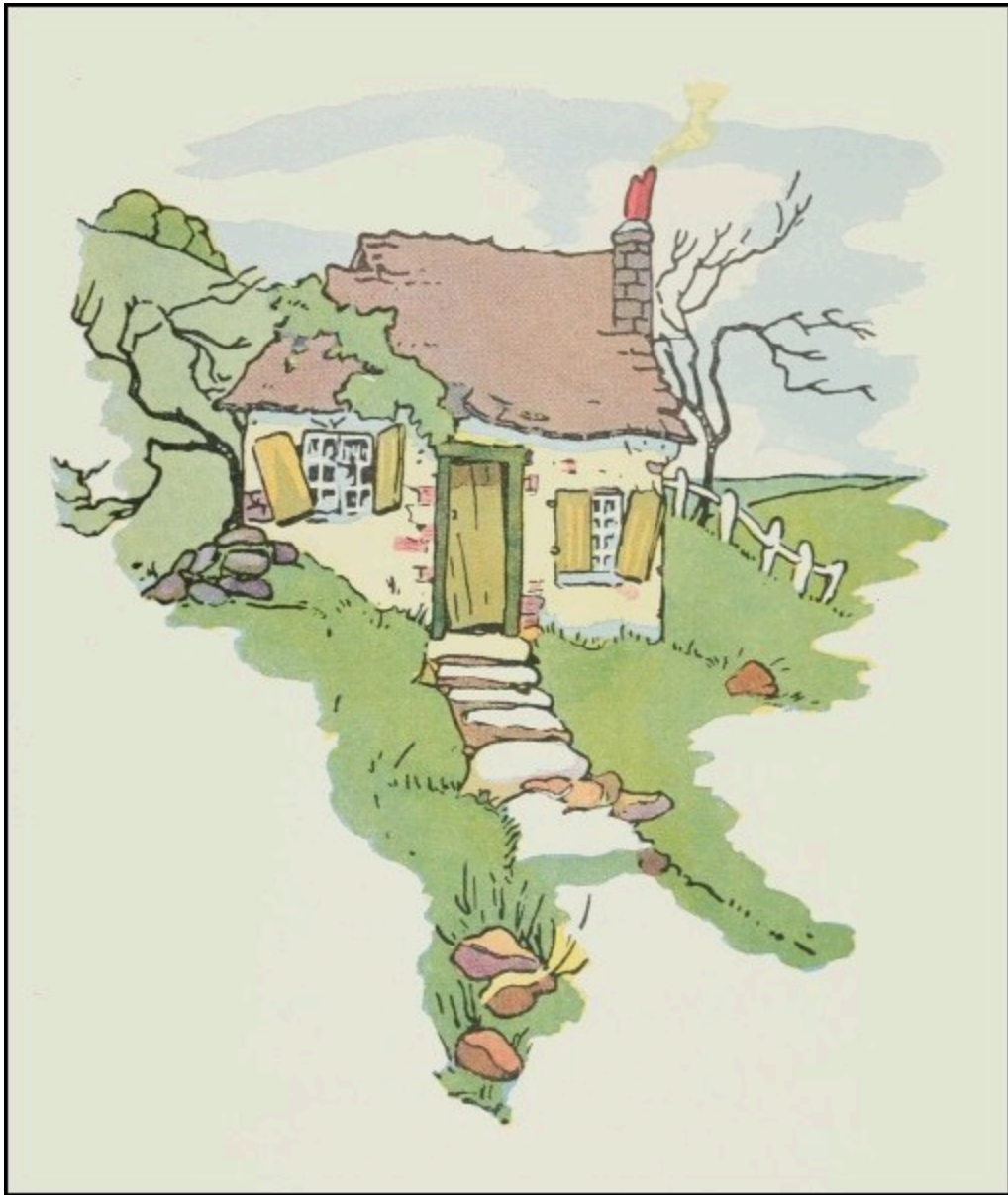
A Little

Red

Hen



On another hill close by
there was another little
house. It was very ugly.

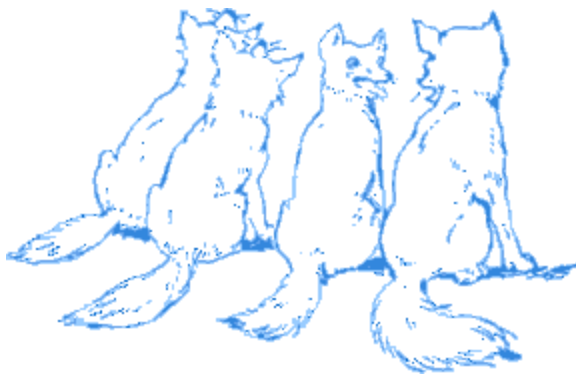


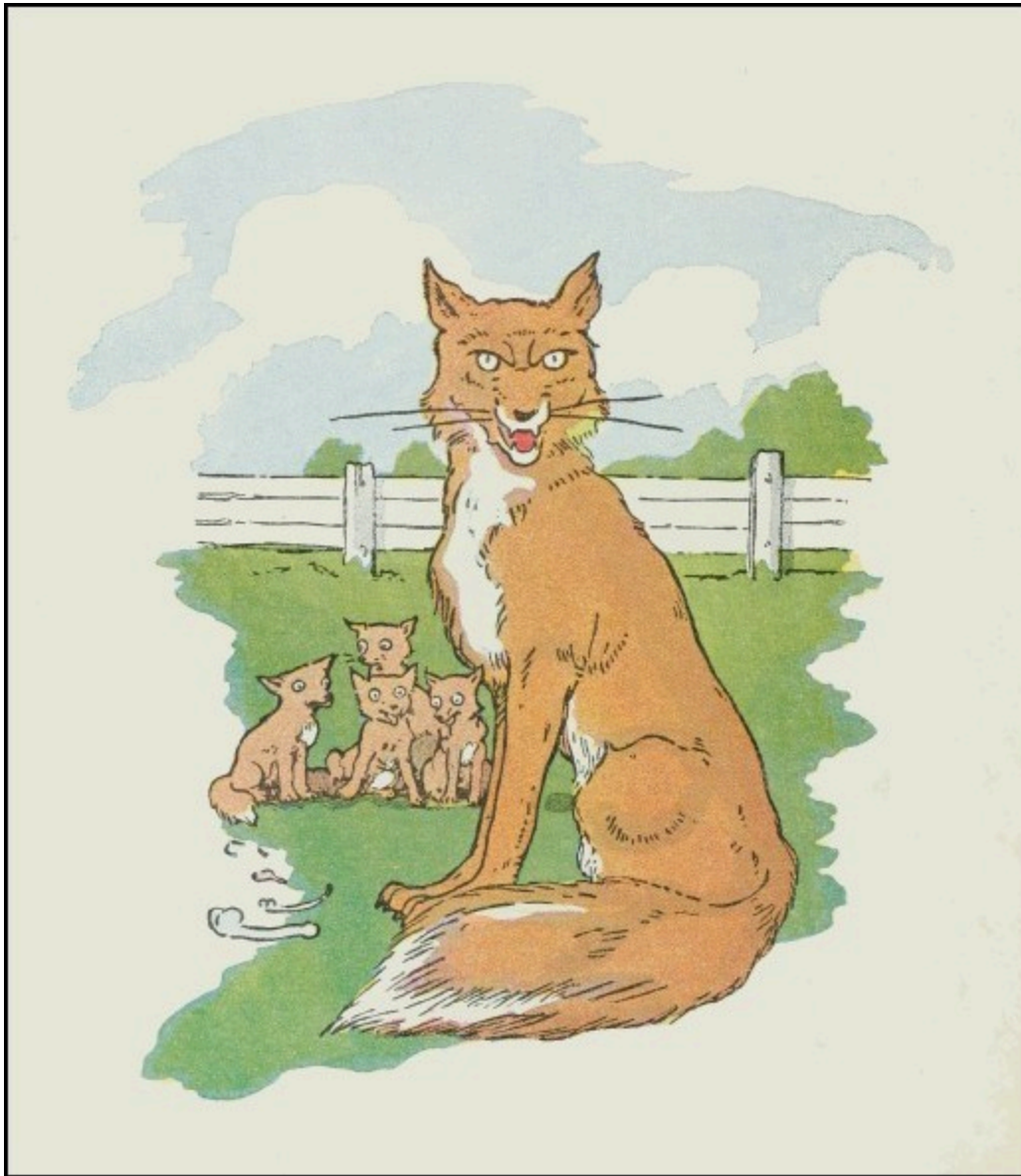
It had a door
that wouldn't shut,



and two broken windows,
and all the paint
was off the shutters

And in this house
there lived





A BOLD BAD FOX
and FOUR BAD

LITTLE FOXES



One morning these
four bad little foxes



came to the
big bad Fox
and said:



“Oh, Father, we’re so
hungry!”

“We had nothing to eat
yesterday,” said one.

“And scarcely anything
the day before,” said another.

“And only half a chicken
the day before that,” said
the third.

“And only two little
ducks the day before that,”
said the fourth.



The big bad Fox shook
his head for a long time,

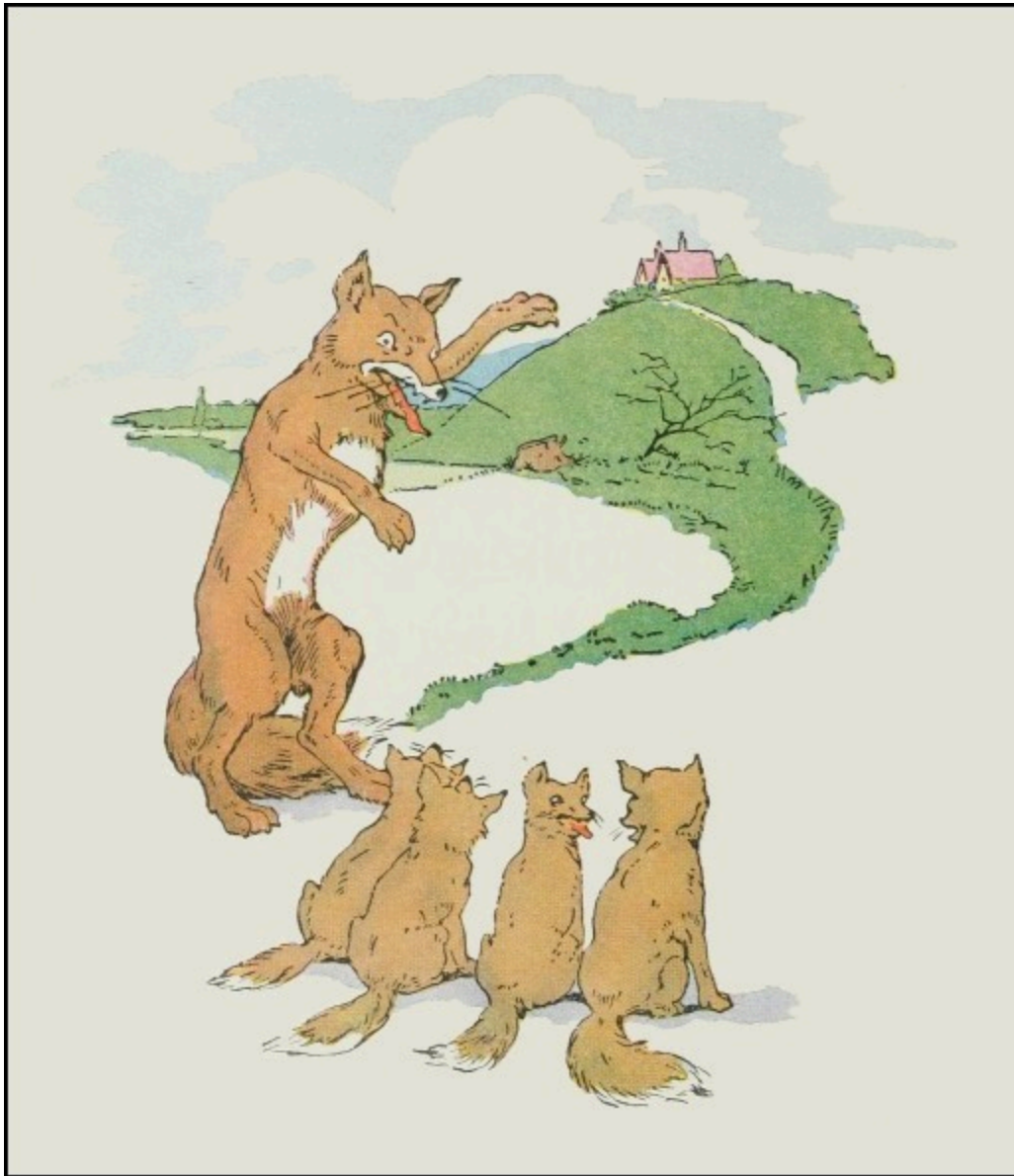
for he was thinking.



At last he said in a
big gruff voice:

“On that hill over there
I see a house. And in that
house there lives a Cock.”

“And a Mouse,” screamed
two of the little foxes.



“And a little Red Hen,”
screamed the other two.

“And they are nice and fat,”
went on the big bad Fox.

“This very day, I’ll take my
great sack, and I will go up
that hill, and in at that door,
and into my sack I will put
the Cock, and the Mouse,
and the little Red Hen.”



“I’ll make a fire
to roast the Cock,”
said one little fox.

“I’ll put on the saucepan
to boil the Hen,”
said the second.



“And I’ll get the frying
pan to fry the Mouse,”
said the third.





“And I’ll have the biggest helping when they are all cooked,” said the fourth, who was the greediest of all.

So the four little foxes jumped for joy, and the big bad Fox went to get his sack ready to start upon his journey.



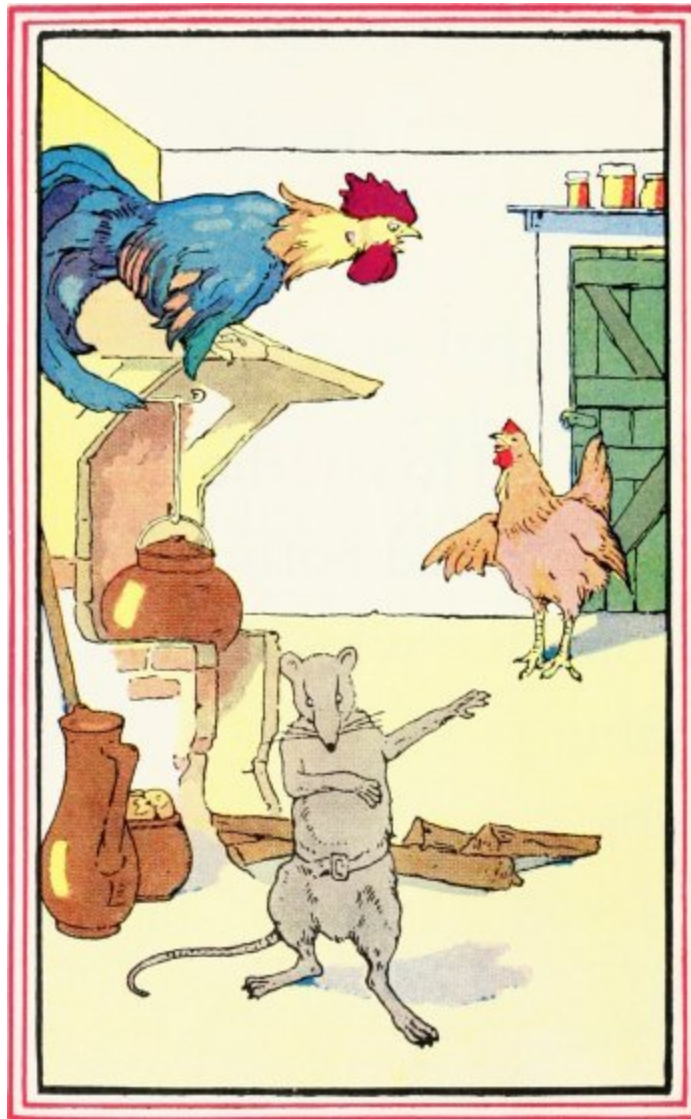
But what was happening
to the Cock and the Mouse,

and the little Red Hen, all
this time?



Well, sad to say, the Cock and
the Mouse had both got out of
bed on the wrong side that
morning.





The Cock said the day was too hot, and the Mouse grumbled because it was too cold.

They came grumbling down
to the kitchen, where the good
little Red Hen, looking as bright
as a sunbeam, was bustling about.

“Who’ll get some sticks to
light the fire with?” she asked.

“*I shan’t,*” said the Cock.

“*I shan’t,*” said the Mouse.

“Then I’ll do it myself,” said
the little Red Hen.

So off she ran to get the sticks.



“And now, who’ll fill
the kettle from the
spring?” she asked.



“I shan’t,”
said the Cock.

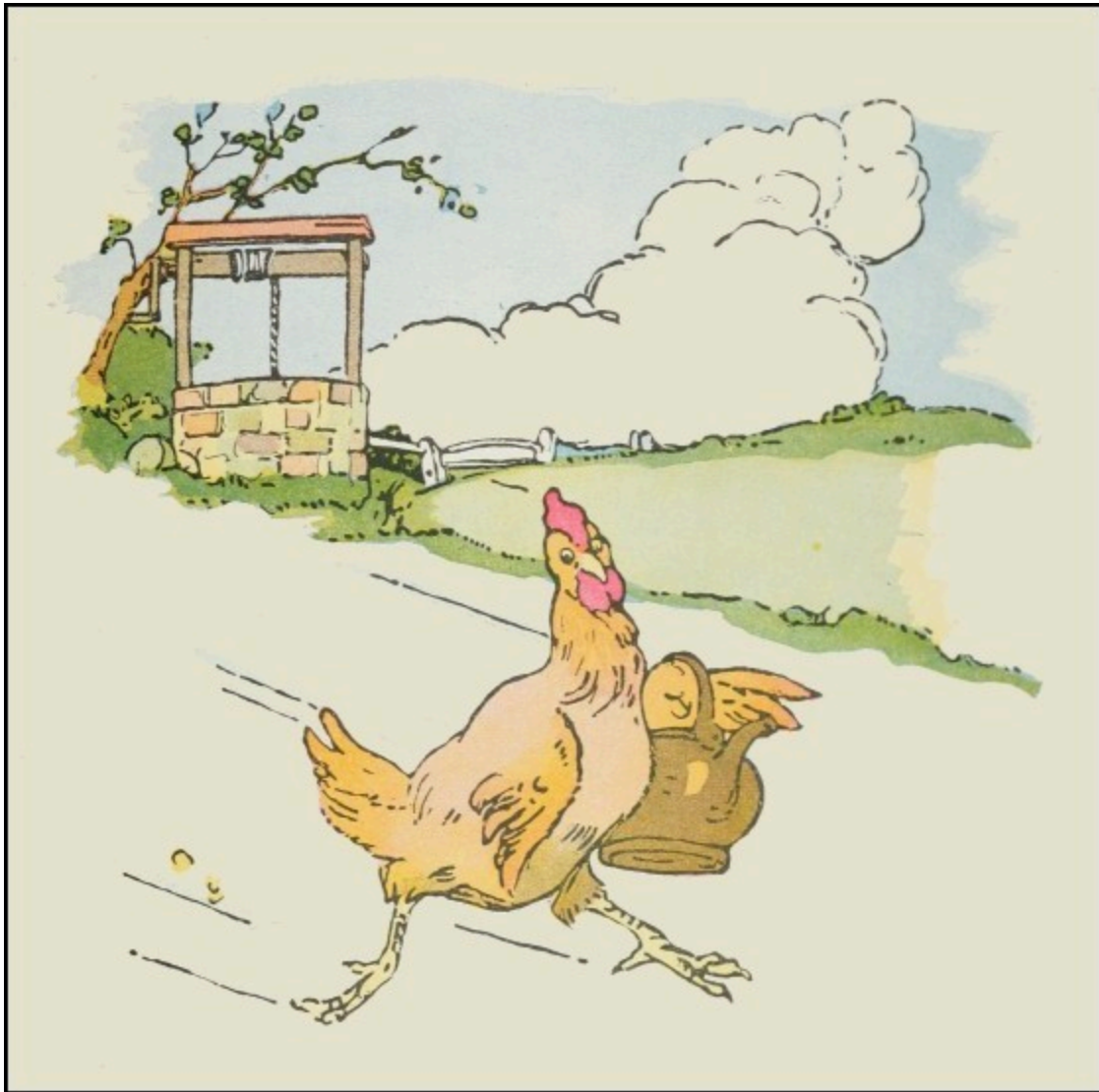
“I shan’t,” said
the Mouse.



“Then I’ll do it myself,”
said the little Red Hen.

And off she ran to
fill the kettle.





“And who’ll get the
breakfast ready?” she

asked, as she put the
kettle on to boil.



“I shan’t,”
said the Cock.



“I shan’t,”
said the Mouse.

“I’ll do it myself,”
said the little Red Hen.



All breakfast time the
Cock and the Mouse quarrelled
and grumbled. The

Cock upset the milk jug,
and the Mouse scattered
crumbs upon the floor.....



“Who’ll clear away the
breakfast?” asked the poor
little Red Hen, hoping



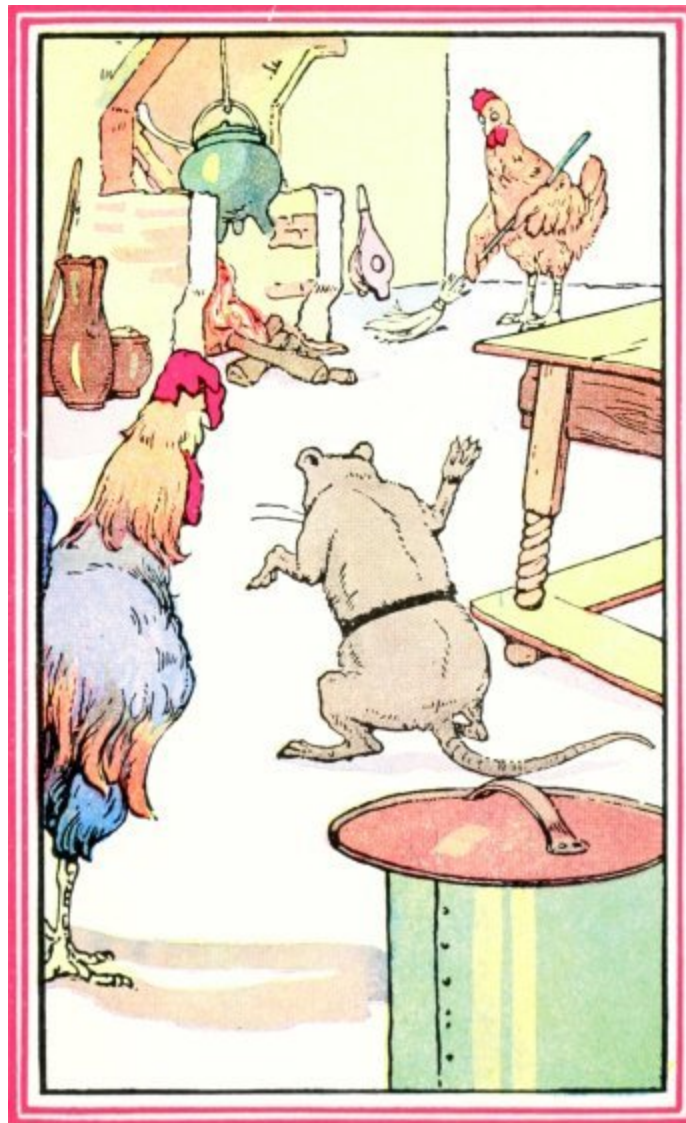
they would soon leave
off being cross.

“I shan’t,” said the Cock.

“I shan’t,” said the Mouse.

“Then I’ll do it myself,”
said the little Red Hen.

So she cleared everything
away, swept up the crumbs,
and brushed up the fireplace.



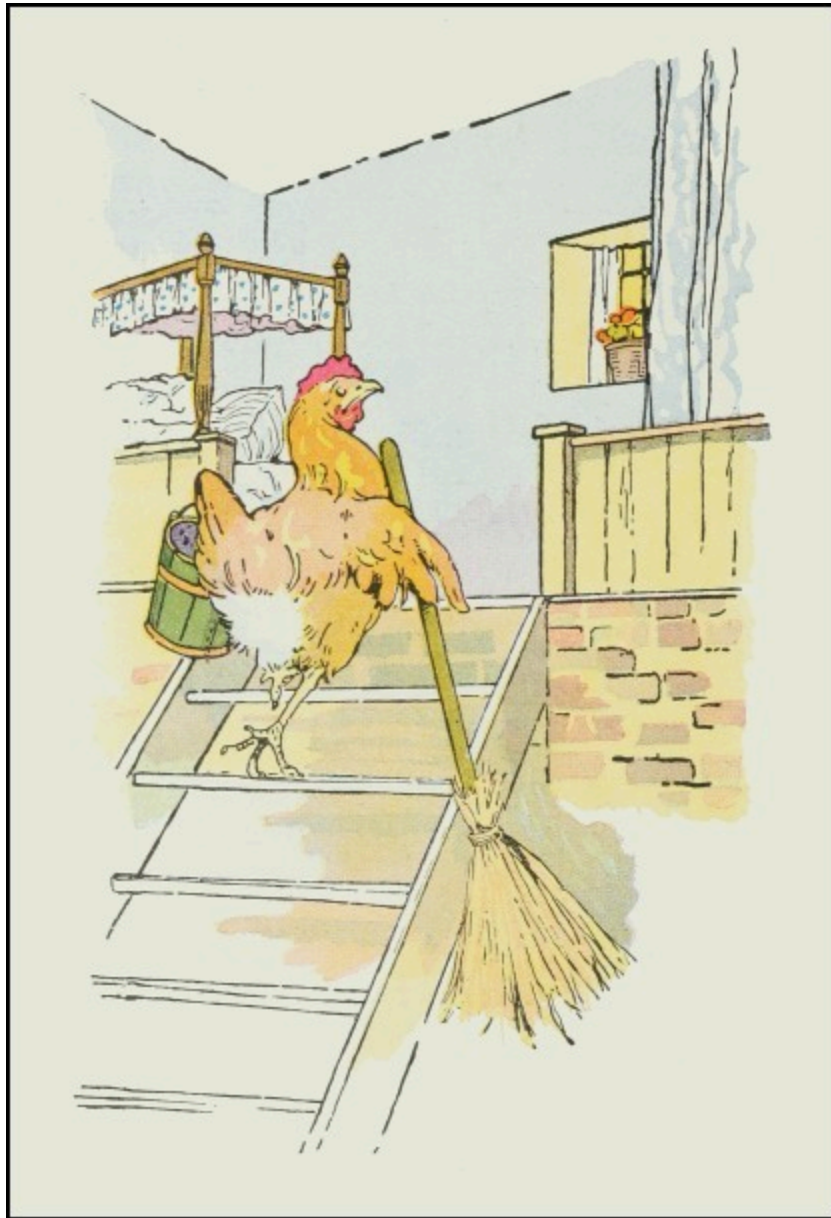


“And now, who’ll help
me to make the beds?”

“*I shan’t*,” said the Cock.

“*I shan’t*,” said the Mouse.





“Then I’ll do it myself,”
said the little Red Hen.

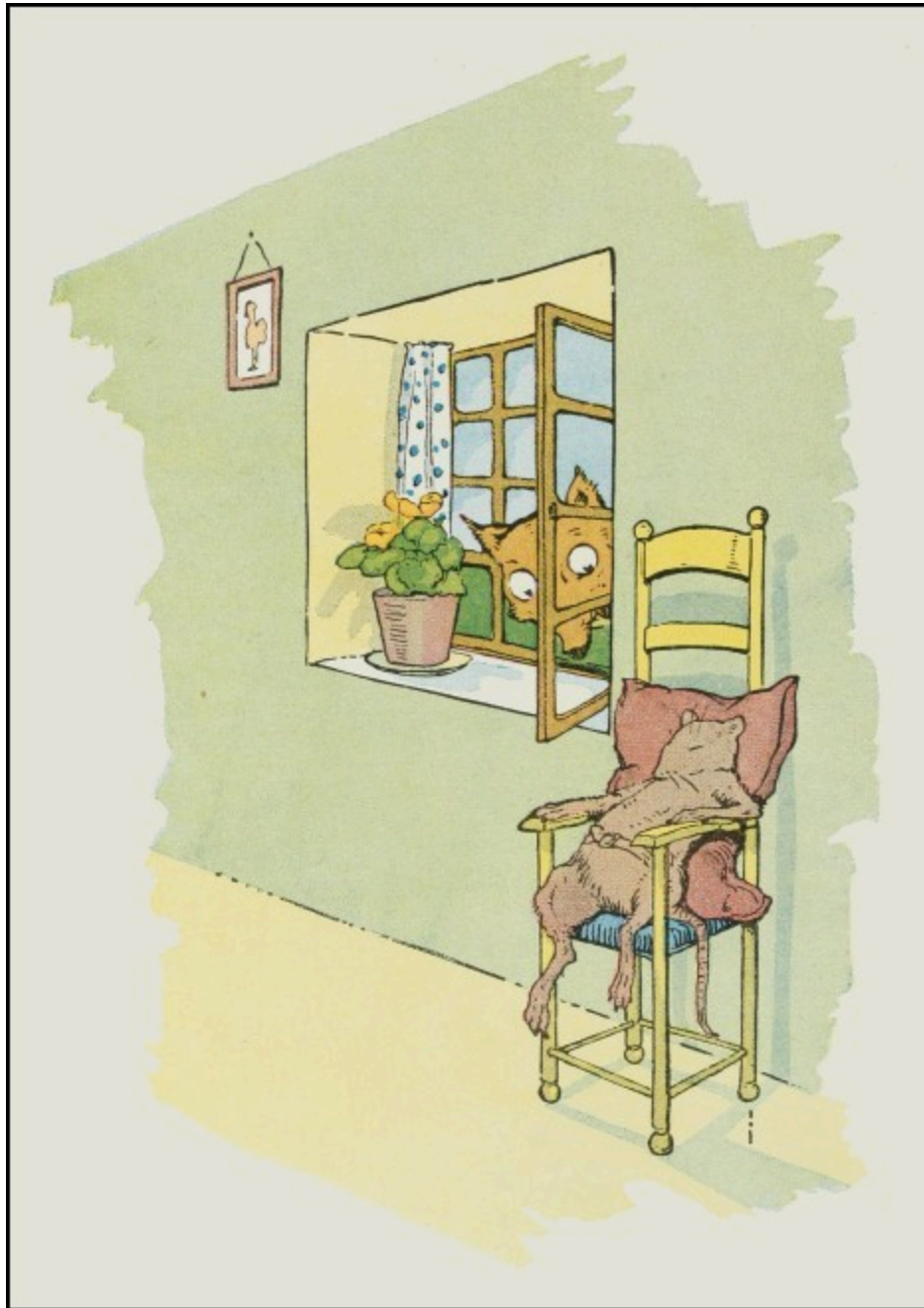
And she tripped away
upstairs.

But the lazy Cock and
Mouse each sat down in a
comfortable arm-chair by
the fire



and soon fell
fast asleep.





Now the bad Fox had
crept up the hill, and into
the garden, and if the Cock
and Mouse hadn't been
asleep, they would have seen
his sharp eyes peeping in
at the window.

“Rat tat tat, Rat tat tat”, the Fox
knocked at the door.



“Who can that be?” said the
Mouse, half opening his eyes.

“Go and look for yourself, if
you want to know,” said the
rude Cock



“It’s the postman perhaps,”
thought the Mouse to himself,
“and he may have a letter

for me.” So without waiting to see who it was, he lifted the latch and opened the door.

As soon as he opened it in jumped the big Fox, with a cruel smile upon his face!





“Oh! oh! oh!” squeaked the
Mouse as he tried to run up
the chimney.

“Doodle doodle do!” screamed
the Cock, as he jumped on the
back of the biggest
arm-chair.....

But the Fox only laughed,
and without more ado he

took the little Mouse by the
tail, and popped him into
the sack, and seized the
Cock by the neck and popped
him in too.





Then the poor little Red
Hen came running down-stairs
to see what all the
noise was about,

and the Fox caught her
and put her into the sack
with the others.





Then he took a long piece of
string out of his pocket, wound
it round and round and

round the mouth of
the sack, and tied it very
tight indeed.



After that he threw the sack
over his back and set off down
the hill.



“Oh! I wish I hadn’t been so cross,” said the Cock, as they went bumping about.

“Oh! I wish I hadn’t been so lazy,” said the Mouse, wiping his eyes with the tip of his tail.

“It’s never too late to mend,” said the little Red Hen. “And don’t be too sad.



See, here I have my little work-bag, and in it there is

a pair of scissors, and a little thimble, and a needle and thread. Very soon you will see what I am going to do.”

Now the sun was very hot, and soon Mr. Fox began to feel his sack was heavy, and at last he thought he would lie down under a tree and go to sleep for a little while.

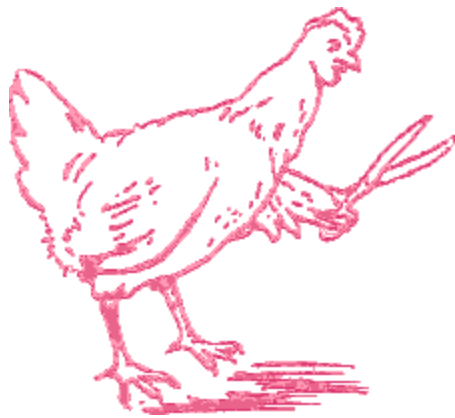




So he threw the sack down
with a big bump, and very

soon fell fast asleep.

Snore, snore, snore, went
the Fox.

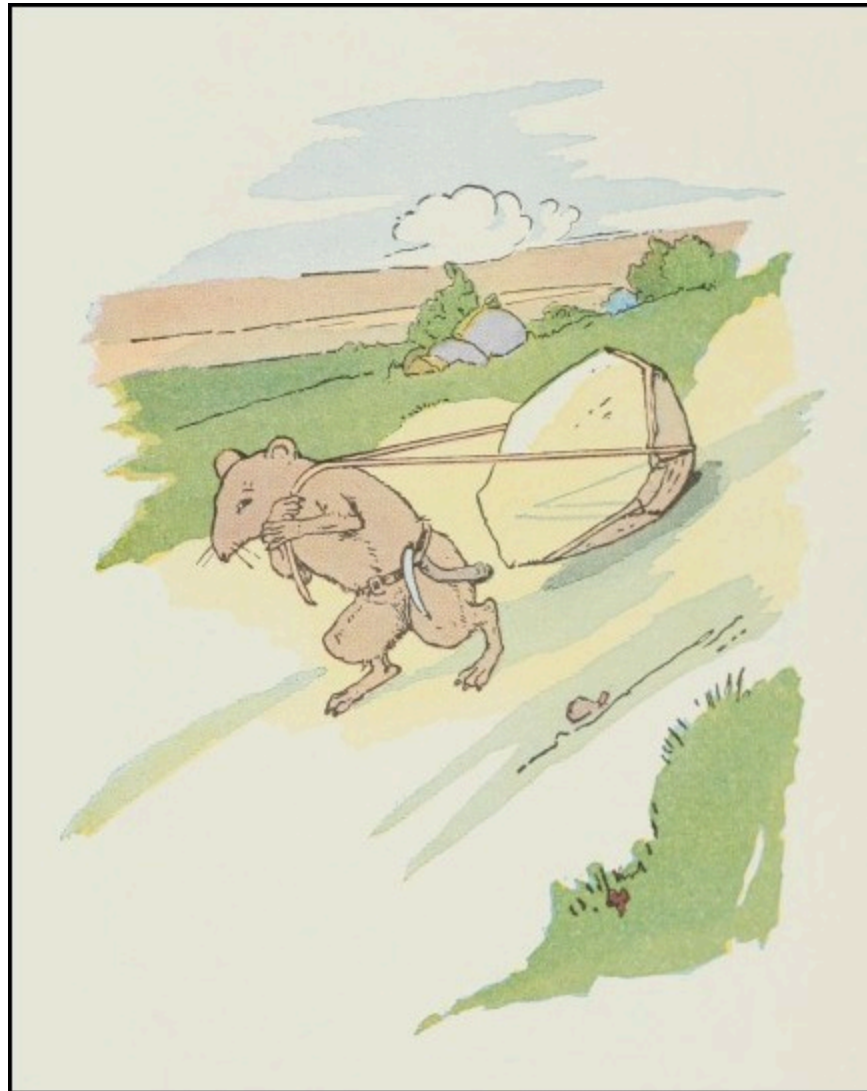


As soon as the little Red
Hen heard this, she took
out her scissors, and began
to snip a hole in the sack,
just large enough for the
Mouse to creep through.

“Quick,” she whispered to the Mouse, “run as fast as you can and bring back a stone just as large as yourself.”



Out scampered the Mouse,
and soon came back, dragging
the stone after him.

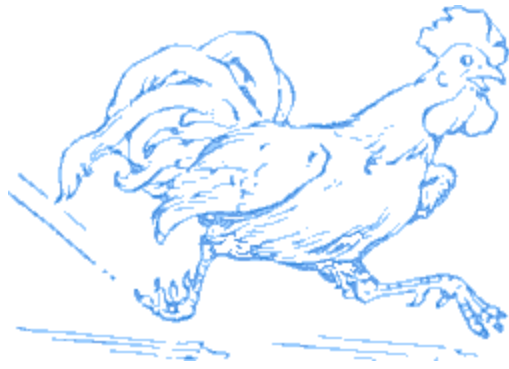




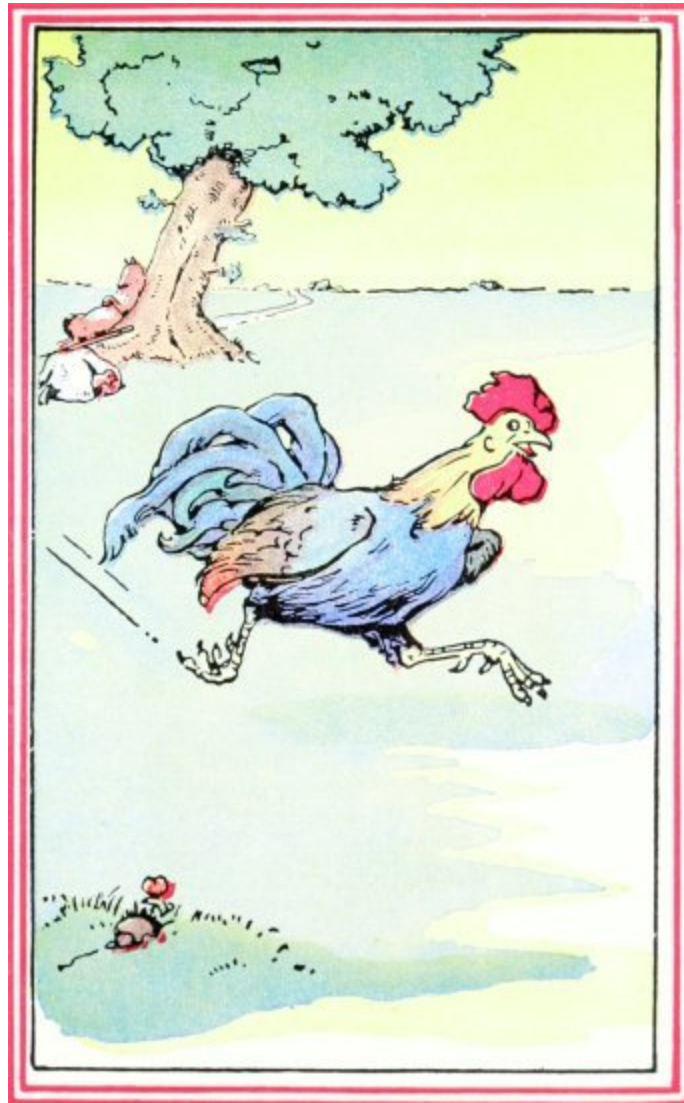
“Push it in here,” said the little Red Hen, and he pushed it in in a twinkling.

Then the little Red Hen snipped away the hole, till it was large enough for the Cock to get through.

“Quick,” she said, “run and get a stone as big as yourself.”



Out flew the Cock, and
soon came back quite out
of breath, with a big stone,
which he pushed into the
sack too.

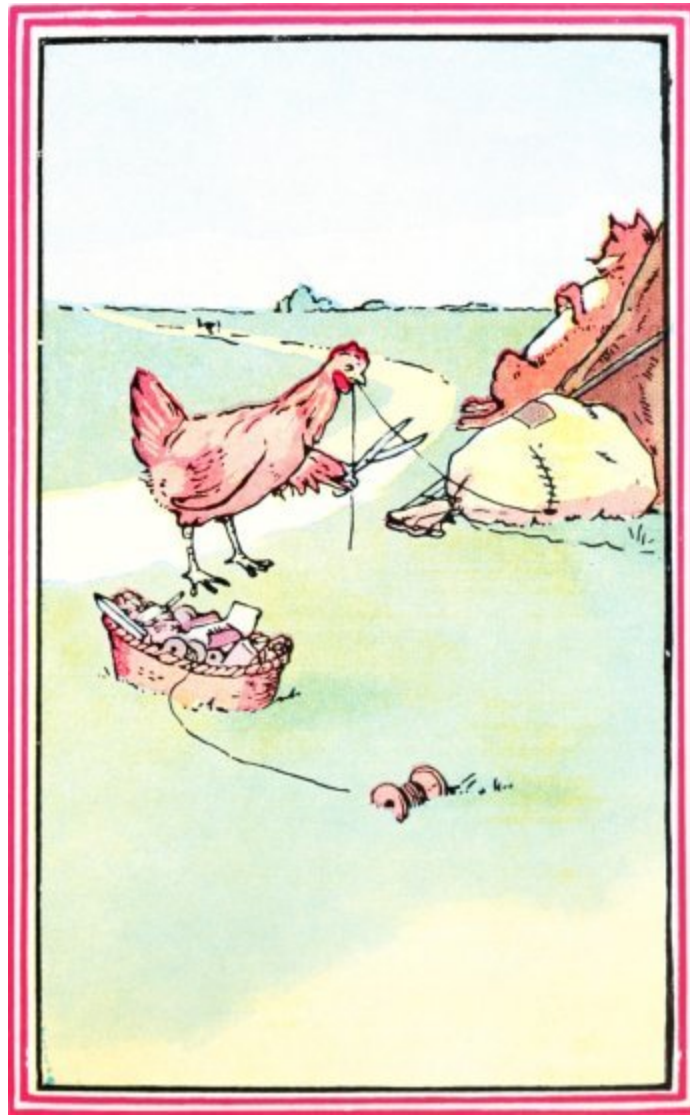


Then the little Red Hen
popped out,



got a stone as big as
herself, and pushed it in.

Next she put on her thimble,
took out her needle and thread,
and sewed up the hole as
quickly as ever she could.



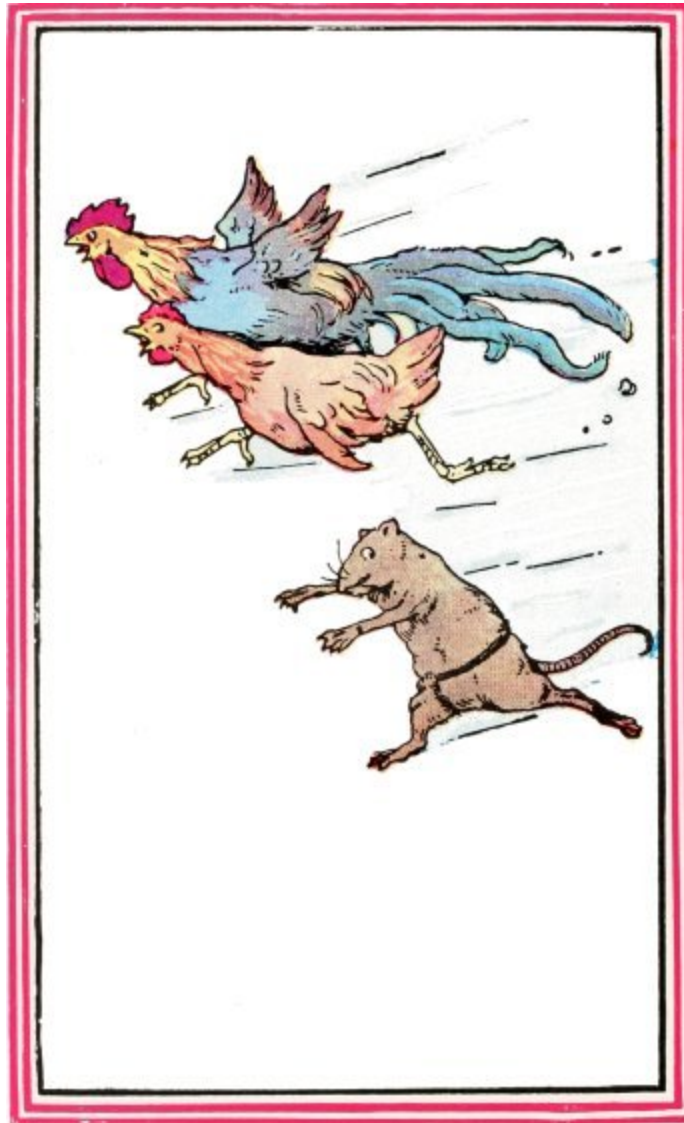
When it was done, the
Cock and the Mouse and

the little Red Hen ran home
very fast, shut the door



after them, drew the bolts,
shut the shutters, and drew
down the blinds and felt
quite safe.





The bad Fox lay fast asleep
under the tree for some time,
but at last he woke up.

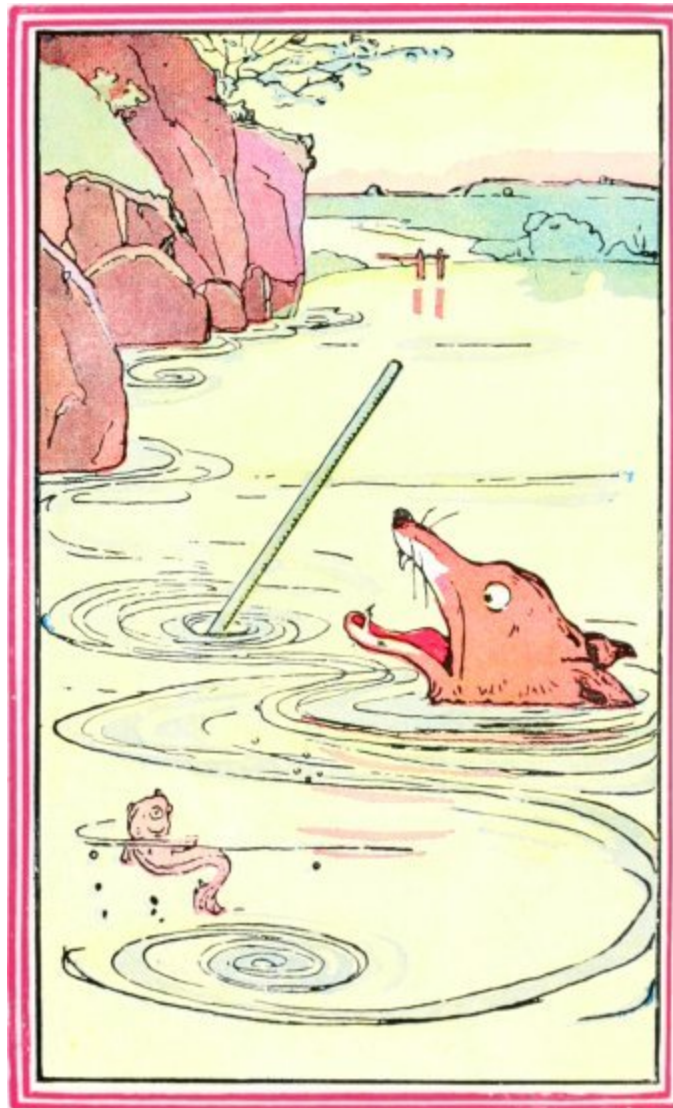
“Dear, dear,” he said, rubbing
his eyes and then looking at
the long shadows on the grass,
“how late it is getting. I must
hurry home.”

So the bad Fox went
grumbling and groaning
down the hill



till he came to the
stream.

Splash! In went one foot.
Splash! In went the other,
but the stones in the sack
were so heavy that at the
very next step down tumbled
Mr. Fox into a deep pool.



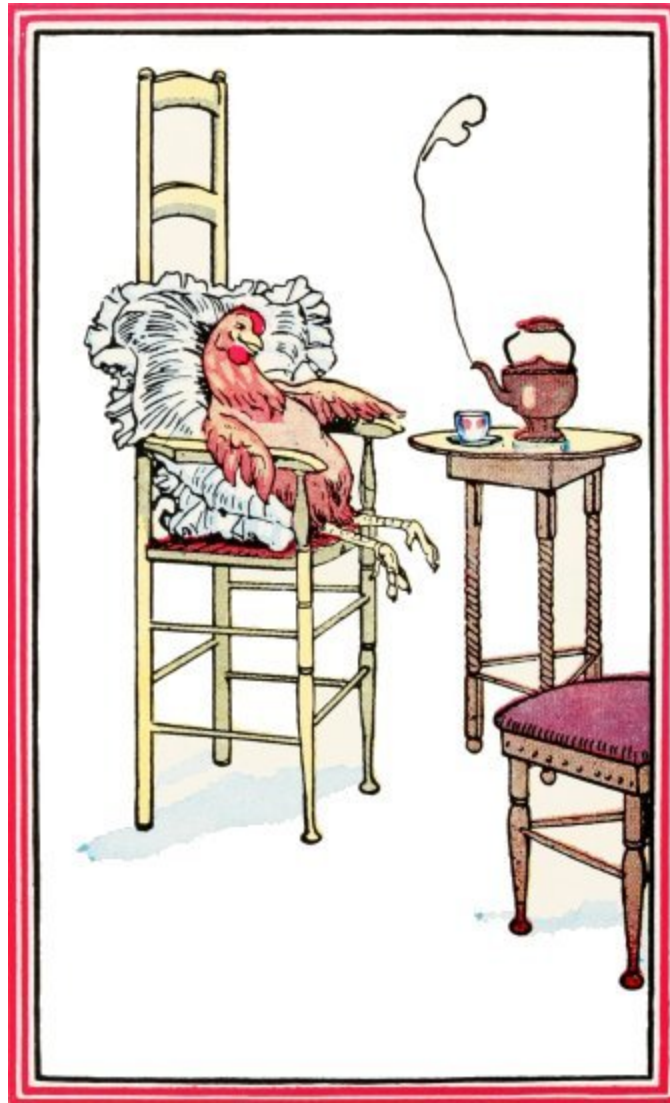
And then the fishes carried
him off to their fairy caves

and kept him a prisoner there,
so he was never seen again.



And the four greedy
little foxes had to go
to bed without any
supper.





But the Cock and the
Mouse never grumbled
again. They lit the fire,

filled the kettle, laid the
breakfast, and did all the
work, while the good little
Red Hen had a holiday, and
sat resting in the big arm-chair.

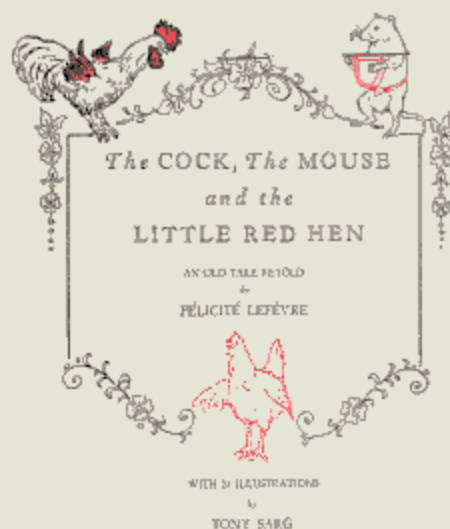
No foxes ever troubled
them again, and for all I
know they are still living
happily in the little house
with the green door and
green shutters, which stands
on the hill.



The End

Thumbnails

If pictures do not show as facing pairs, you may need to make your browser window a little wider.



TO MY NIECES
 CECILIA GARRY and NELLY MELVILLE
 AND
 TO MY LITTLE FRIEND
 HARFORD LURY
 THIS BOOK IS DEDICATED
 WITH MY LOVE

THE COCK, THE MOUSE
 AND THE LITTLE RED HEN

4511
 SEVENTEENTH PRINTING
Manufactured in the United States of America

Once upon a time there was
a hill, and on the hill there
was a pretty little house.

It had one little green
door, and four little win-
dows with green shutters,
and in it there lived



A Cock



and A Mouse

and
A Little
Red
Hen



On another hill close by
there was another little
house. It was very ugly.



It had a door
that wouldn't shut,



and two broken win-
dows, and all the paint
was off the shutters

And in this house
there lived





A BOLD BAD FOX
and FOUR BAD
LITTLE FOXES



One morning these
four bad little foxes



came to the
big bad Fox
and said:



"Oh, Father, we're so hungry!"

"We had nothing to eat yesterday," said one.

"And scarcely anything the day before," said another.

"And only half a chicken the day before that," said the third.

"And only two little ducks the day before that," said the fourth.



The big bad Fox shook
his head for a long time,
for he was thinking.

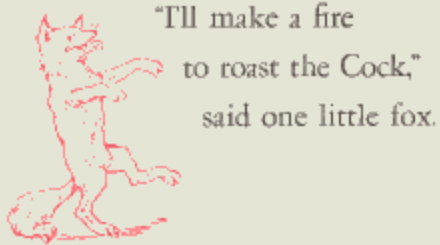


At last he said in a
big gruff voice:
"On that hill over there
I see a house. And in that
house there lives a Cock."
"And a Mouse," screamed
two of the little foxes.



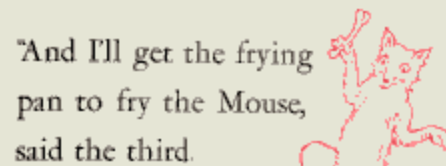
"And a little Red Hen,"
screamed the other two.

"And they are nice and fat,"
went on the big bad Fox.
"This very day, I'll take my
great sack, and I will go up
that hill, and in at that door,
and into my sack I will put
the Cock, and the Mouse,
and the little Red Hen."



"I'll make a fire
to roast the Cock,"
said one little fox.

"I'll put on the saucepan
to boil the Hen,"
said the second.



"And I'll get the frying
pan to fry the Mouse,
said the third.



"And I'll have the big-
gest helping when
they are all cooked,"
said the fourth, who
was the greediest of all.

So the four little foxes
jumped for joy, and the
big bad Fox went to get
his sack ready to start
upon his journey.



But what was happening
to the Cock and the Mouse,
and the little Red Hen, all
this time?



Well, sad to say, the Cock and
the Mouse had both got out of
bed on the wrong side that
morning.





The Cock said the day was too hot, and the Mouse grumbled because it was too cold.

They came grumbling down to the kitchen, where the good little Red Hen, looking as bright as a sunbeam, was bustling about.

"Who'll get some sticks to light the fire with?" she asked.

"I shan't," said the Cock.

"I shan't," said the Mouse.

"Then I'll do it myself," said the little Red Hen.

So off she ran to get the sticks.



"And now, who'll fill the kettle from the spring?" she asked.

"I shan't," said the Cock.



"I shan't," said the Mouse.



"Then I'll do it myself,"
said the little Red Hen."
And off she ran to
fill the kettle.



"And who'll get the
breakfast ready?" she
asked, as she put the
kettle on to boil.



"I shan't,"
said the Cock.



"I shan't,"
said the Mouse.

"I'll do it myself,"
said the little Red Hen.



All breakfast time the Cock and the Mouse quarrelled and grumbled. The Cock upset the milk jug, and the Mouse scattered crumbs upon the floor.



"Who'll clear away the breakfast?" asked the poor little Red Hen, hoping



they would soon leave off being cross.

"I shan't," said the Cock.
"I shan't," said the Mouse.
"Then I'll do it myself,"
said the little Red Hen.
So she cleared everything
away, swept up the crumbs,
and brushed up the fireplace.



"And now, who'll help
me to make the beds?"

"I shan't," said the Cock.
"I shan't," said the Mouse.





"Then I'll do it myself,"
said the little Red Hen.
And she tripped away
upstairs.

But the lazy Cock and
Mouse each sat down in a
comfortable arm-chair by
the fire



and soon fell
fast asleep.





Now the bad Fox had crept up the hill, and into the garden, and if the Cock and Mouse hadn't been asleep, they would have seen his sharp eyes peeping in at the window.

"Rat tat tat, Rat tat tat",
the Fox knocked at the door.



"Who can that be?" said the
Mouse, half opening his eyes.

"Go and look for yourself, if
you want to know," said the
rude Cock



"It's the postman perhaps," thought the Mouse to himself, "and he may have a letter for me." So without waiting to see who it was, he lifted the latch and opened the door.

As soon as he opened it in jumped the big Fox, with a cruel smile upon his face!



"Oh! oh! oh!" squeaked the Mouse as he tried to run up the chimney.
"Doodle doodle do!" screamed the Cock, as he jumped on the back of the biggest arm-chair

But the Fox only laughed,
and without more ado he
took the little Mouse by the
tail, and popped him into
the sack, and seized the
Cock by the neck and pop-
ped him in too.



Then the poor little Red
Hen came running down-
stairs to see what all the
noise was about,

and the Fox caught her
and put her into the sack
with the others.





Then he took a long piece of string out of his pocket, wound it round and round and round the mouth of the sack, and tied it very tight indeed.



After that he threw the sack over his back and set off down the hill.



"Oh! I wish I hadn't been so cross," said the Cock, as they went bumping about.

"Oh! I wish I hadn't been so lazy," said the Mouse, wiping his eyes with the tip of his tail.

"It's never too late to mend," said the little Red Hen. "And don't be too sad.

See, here I have my little work-bag, and in it there is a pair of scissors, and a little thimble, and a needle and thread. Very soon you will see what I am going to do."



Now the sun was very hot, and soon Mr. Fox began to feel his sack was heavy, and at last he thought he would lie down under a tree and go to sleep for a little while.





So he threw the sack down
with a big bump, and very
soon fell fast asleep.

Snore, snore, snore, went
the Fox.



As soon as the little Red
Hen heard this, she took
out her scissors, and began
to snip a hole in the sack,
just large enough for the
Mouse to creep through.

"Quick," she whispered to
the Mouse, "run as fast as you
can and bring back a stone
just as large as yourself."



Out scampered the Mouse,
and soon came back, drag-
ging the stone after him.



"Push it in here," said
the little Red Hen, and he
pushed it in in a twinkling.

Then the little Red Hen
snipped away the hole, till
it was large enough for the
Cock to get through.

"Quick," she said, "run
and get a stone as big as
yourself."



Out flew the Cock, and
soon came back quite out
of breath, with a big stone,
which he pushed into the
sack too.



Then the little Red Hen
popped out,



got a stone as big as
herself, and pushed it in.

Next she put on her thimble,
took out her needle and thread,
and sewed up the hole as
quickly as ever she could.



When it was done, the
Cock and the Mouse and
the little Red Hen ran home
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after them, drew the bolts,
shut the shutters, and drew
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quite safe.





The bad Fox lay fast asleep
under the tree for some time,
but at last he woke up.

"Dear, dear," he said, rubbing
his eyes and then looking at
the long shadows on the grass,
"how late it is getting. I must
hurry home."

So the bad Fox went
grumbling and groaning
down the hill



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Splash! In went one foot.
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but the stones in the sack
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And then the fishes carried
him off to their fairy caves
and kept him a prisoner there,
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And the four greedy
little foxes had to go
to bed without any
supper.





But the Cock and the Mouse never grumbled again. They lit the fire, filled the kettle, laid the breakfast, and did all the work, while the good little Red Hen had a holiday, and sat resting in the big arm-chair.

No foxes ever troubled them again, and for all I know they are still living happily in the little house with the green door and green shutters, which stands on the hill.



The End

Title Page Text

The COCK, *The* MOUSE
and the
LITTLE RED HEN
AN OLD TALE RETOLD
by
FÉLICITÉ LEFÈVRE

WITH 24 ILLUSTRATIONS
by
TONY SARG
MACRAE · SMITH · COMPANY
PHILADELPHIA



Technical Note on Colors

The colors used in the line drawings represent the transcriber's best guess. To try an alternative version, do one of two things: Open the "images" directory, rename the folder **line_main** (to anything) and then rename **line_alt** to **line_main**. Or, if you are comfortable editing HTML text, globally change **line_main** to **line_alt** in this file. (The Technical Note has been

formatted so you will not accidentally change anything in this paragraph.) Save under a new name to keep both versions.

The illustrations with a gold background are taken from the endpapers.

*** END OF THE PROJECT GUTENBERG EBOOK THE COCK, THE
MOUSE, AND THE LITTLE RED HEN ***

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